

The governance dial — worked examples

The same document collection, the same question, the governance knob turned one click at a time. Every output is **verbatim** from the sealed run archives; correctness verdicts are from the independent LLM judge (gemini-3.1-pro-preview). Generation model identical in every row — the only thing that changes is governance.

G0 · no governance (naive RAG)

G1 · answers must cite sources

G2 · evidence must be authorized & grounded

G3 · strict authorization

G4 · corroboration required

Part A — Feel the knob (one corpus, DelucionQA: document and domain held constant)

A1 · The staircase: the answer survives, tightens, then stops.

A1 · STAIRCASE (RECOMMENDED)

“Can the steering wheel warm up in winter?”

Answerable · staircase profile · record delucionqa_q00239

Four distinct behaviors in five clicks: plain answer → cited answer with extra detail → visibly narrower answer from a stricter evidence pool → blocked. The knob is doing something different at every setting.

G0 · Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, yes. The steering wheel contains a heating element designed to help warm your hands in cold weather.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 · Cited

citations required

Yes, the steering wheel can warm up in cold weather. It contains a heating element designed to help warm your hands [\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_2647, CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_2657\]](#). Additionally, when Remote Start is activated in cold weather, the heated steering wheel will automatically turn on if it is programmed in the Comfort menu screen within Uconnect Settings [\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_2653\]](#).

✓ correct + cited

G2 · Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

Yes, the vehicle features a heated steering wheel. The heated steering wheel button is located on the center of the instrument panel below the radio screen, and within

✓ correct + cited

the Climate or Controls screen of the touchscreen

[\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_2652\]](#).

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G4 • Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

A1 • STAIRCASE (ALTERNATE)

“Is the internal wireless radio safe for human?”

Answerable • staircase profile • record delucionqa_q00004

Same profile on a safety-flavored question: the citation appears at G1, the answer tightens to the FCC-limits core at G2, and strict authorization declines from G3.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, the radio manufacturer believes the internal wireless radio is safe for use by consumers.

Additionally, the context states that:

- * The radiated output power of the radio is far below the FCC and IC radio frequency exposure limits.

- * It operates within guidelines found in radio frequency safety standards and recommendations.

- * It must be used in a manner where the radio is 8 inches (20 cm) or further from

the human body.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 • Cited

citations required

Yes, the radio manufacturer believes the internal wireless radio is safe for use by consumers [\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_58\]](#).

The device operates within guidelines found in radio frequency safety standards and recommendations, and its radiated output power is far below the FCC and IC radio frequency exposure limits

[\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPORT_58\]](#). However, to ensure safety, the wireless radio must be used in such a manner that it remains 8

✓ correct + cited

G2 • Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

Yes, the radio manufacturer believes the internal wireless radio is safe for use by consumers. Its radiated output power is far below the FCC and IC radio frequency exposure limits, provided it is used in a manner where the radio is 8 inches (20 cm) or further from the human body
[CHNK_PRIMARY].

✓ correct + cited

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G4 • Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

A1 • STAIRCASE (ALTERNATE, LONG-FORM)

“Any tips for hill climbing?”

Answerable • staircase profile • record delucionqa_q00193

A multi-part advisory answer that shrinks as evidence tightens — G1 cites per tip, G2 keeps only primary-chunk-grounded tips, G3 declines.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the provided text, here are the tips for hill climbing:

✓ correct — uncited

****Preparation and Assessment****
* ****Know your limits:**** Have a good understanding of your abilities and your vehicle's limitations. Only attempt a climb if you feel confident.
* ****Assess the hill before proceeding:****
* Consider its grade (steepness) and determine if it is too steep.
* Check the traction on the trail.
* Ensure the trail goes straight up

G1 • Cited

citations required

Based on the provided evidence, here are the key tips for hill climbing:

✓ correct + cited

* ****Preparation and Assessment****: Hill climbing ****requires**** good judgment and a solid understanding of your vehicle's

limitations

[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_224]. Before attempting a climb, evaluate the hill's grade, check the traction on the trail, look for obstacles (such as ruts, rocks, or branches), and ensure you can safely recover the vehicle if something goes wrong

G2 • Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

Based on the provided evidence, tips for hill climbing include:

- * It requires good judgment and a thorough understanding of your abilities and your vehicle's limitations [CHNK_PRIMARY].
- * You should always feel confident with the vehicle and your abilities before attempting a climb [CHNK_PRIMARY].
- * Always climb hills straight up and down [CHNK_PRIMARY].
- * Avoid attempting to climb hills that are too steep, as they can cause serious

✓ correct + cited

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G4 • Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

A2 • The reshapar: the system answers at every level, but the answer visibly changes.

A2 • RESHAPING (RECOMMENDED)

“How can I avoid fuel overfilling?”

Answerable • answers at all levels • record delucionqa_q00142

Governance never refuses here — instead the answer degrades gracefully: crisp advice at G0, three citations at G1, then a terse single-citation answer from G2 up. The knob reshapes the answer rather than stopping it.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, you can avoid fuel overfilling by not "topping off" the fuel tank after filling.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 • Cited

citations required

To avoid fuel overfilling, do not "top off" the fuel tank after filling

✓ correct + cited

[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_232],
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1809],
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1846].
Additionally, the manual warns against
overfilling.

G2 • Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

To avoid overfilling, refer to the manual,
which warns about overfilling
[CHNK_PRIMARY].

✗ answered — judge: WRONG

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

To avoid overfilling, refer to the manual,
which warns about overfilling
[CHNK_PRIMARY].

✗ answered — judge: WRONG

G4 • Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

To avoid overfilling, refer to the manual,
which warns of overfilling [CHNK_PRIMARY].

✗ answered — judge: WRONG

A2 • RESHAPING (ALTERNATE)

“What is the distance range that the remote start system can reach?”

Answerable • answers at all levels • record delucionqa_q00081

The factual core (328 ft / 100 m) is stable at every level while the citation set visibly grows
and re-forms as each gate re-filters the evidence — provenance itself is what the knob tunes.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, the remote
start system has a range of approximately
328 ft (100 m) for diesel vehicles, and 328
ft (100 m) for gasoline vehicles.
Obstructions between the vehicle and the
key fob may reduce this range.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 • Cited

citations required

The remote start system has a range of
approximately 328 ft (100 m)
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_249]
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1202]
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1208]. This
range may be reduced by obstructions
between the vehicle and the key fob
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_250].

✓ correct + cited

G2 • Grounded

The Remote Start system has a range of
approximately 328 ft (100 m)

✓ correct + cited

authorized +
grounded evidence

[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1202,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1207,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1288,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_4707], or 328 ft
(100 m) for gasoline models
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1208,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1282].

G3 · Strict

strict authorization

The Remote Start system has a range of
approximately 328 ft (100 m)
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1202,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1207,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1208,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1282,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1288,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_4707].

✓ correct + cited

**G4 ·
Corroborated**

multi-source
corroboration

The Remote Start system has a range of
approximately 328 ft (100 m)
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1202,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1207,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1288,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_4707], or 328 ft
(100 m) for gasoline models
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1208,
CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1282].

✓ correct + cited

A3 · The cost: governance overreaches — the failure case, reported not hidden.

A3 · FALSE REJECTION (RECOMMENDED)

“What does the Cruise Control do?”

Answerable · false-rejection profile · record delucionqa_q00022

A trivially answerable question with judged-correct answers at G0 and G1 — refused from G2 upward. This is one of the 54% of answerable DelucionQA questions lost at the authorization step: the coverage price of strictness, embodied.

G0 · Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, when
engaged, the Cruise Control system takes
over accelerator operations at speeds
greater than 20 mph (32 km/h).
Additionally, if you press the accelerator
to pass while Cruise Control is set, the
system will return the vehicle to the set
speed once the pedal is released.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 · Cited
citations required

When engaged, the Cruise Control system takes over accelerator operations at speeds greater than 20 mph (32 km/h)
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_370, CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_1298, CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_4828].

✓ correct + cited

G2 · Grounded
authorized +
grounded evidence

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

— refused

G3 · Strict
strict authorization

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

— refused

G4 · Corroborated
multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

— refused

A3 · FALSE REJECTION (ALTERNATE)

“If a tire is marked C, what does this mean?”

Answerable · false-rejection profile · record delucionqa_q00021

Same failure with the harder block message: a correct multi-part answer at G1, then authorization refuses the tire-grading evidence outright.

G0 · Naive
no governance

Based on the provided context, a tire marked "C" can mean two things depending on the grading category:

✓ correct — uncited

1. ****Traction:**** A tire marked C may have poor traction performance (representing the lowest traction grade).
2. ****Temperature:**** The grade C corresponds to the minimum level of performance (resistance to heat generation and ability to dissipate heat) that all passenger vehicle tires must meet under the Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standard No. 109.

G1 · Cited
citations required

Depending on the category, a tire marked ****C**** indicates the following:

✓ correct + cited

* ****Traction Grade:**** A tire marked C may have poor traction performance, which represents its ability to stop on wet pavement under controlled conditions
[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_364],

[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_366].

* **Temperature Grade:** It represents the tire's resistance to the generation of heat and its ability to dissipate heat when tested under controlled laboratory

G2 · Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G3 · Strict

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G4 · Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

A3 · NON-MONOTONE CURIOSITY (LIMITATIONS FOOTNOTE, NOT HEADLINE)

“The engine fails to start. What can I do now?”

Answerable · non-monotone profile · record delucionqa_q00016

An honest oddity: G2 refuses, but G3/G4 answer — with worse content from a different evidence slice. The gate stack is not perfectly nested; disclosed in Limitations.

G0 · Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, if your engine fails to start (and the vehicle has not experienced an extended park condition), it may be flooded. You can take the following steps:

* **Clear a flooded engine:**

1. Push the accelerator pedal all the way to the floor and hold it there.
2. Crank the engine for no more than 10 seconds. (To prevent starter damage, do not continuously crank for more than 10 seconds at a time, and wait 10 to 15 seconds before

✓ correct — uncited

G1 · Cited

citations required

If the engine fails to start after the operator **performs** the "Normal Starting" procedure, the engine may be flooded [CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_260, CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_641]. When the vehicle **requires** a **start**, you can

✓ correct + cited

take the following actions:

1. ****Clear a Flooded Engine****: Push the accelerator pedal all the way to the floor and hold it there. Crank the engine for no more than 10 seconds to clear excess fuel [\[CHNK RPUS CUSTOMER SUPPOR 260\]](#).

G2 • Grounded

authorized +
grounded evidence

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

— refused

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

Based on the provided evidence, you must not operate the engine with failed parts. You should be alert for changes in performance, sounds, and visual evidence (such as severe vibrating, misfiring, sudden loss of power, unusual noises, or leaks) indicating that the engine requires service [\[CHNK_PRIMARY\]](#). To attempt a start, the operator performs the Normal Starting procedure [Tier 1 Symbolic Triplets].

✗ answered — judge: WRONG

G4 • Corroborated

multi-source
corroboration

Based on the provided evidence, you must not operate the engine with failed parts. You should be alert for changes in performance, sounds, and visual evidence (such as severe vibrating, misfiring, sudden loss of power, unusual noises, or leaks) indicating that the engine requires service [\[CHNK_PRIMARY\]](#). To attempt a start, the operator performs the Normal Starting procedure [Tier 1 Symbolic Triplets].

✗ answered — judge: WRONG

Part B — The same knob across three corpora (why the frontier has three shapes)

B1 • DELUCIONQA — THE SLOPE (98% ONTOLOGY-ALIGNED)

“The LED light on the key fob no longer illuminates. What does this mean?”

Answerable • in-ontology corpus • record delucionqa_q00036

On the in-ontology corpus the dial degrades gracefully: the answer survives three tightening steps with an auditable citation, and only multi-source corroboration declines.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, if the LED light on the key fob no longer illuminates from button pushes, it means that the key fob battery requires replacement.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 • Cited

citations required

This indicates that the key fob battery requires replacement
[\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_582\]](#).

✓ correct + cited

G2 • Groundedauthorized +
grounded evidence

This means that the key fob battery requires replacement
[\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_582\]](#).

✓ correct + cited

G3 • Strict

strict authorization

This means that the key fob battery requires replacement
[\[CHNK_RPUS_CUSTOMER_SUPPOR_582\]](#).

✓ correct + cited

G4 • Corroboratedmulti-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

B2 • HAGRID — THE CLIFF (26% ALIGNED)**“What state is directly north of North Carolina?”**

Answerable · out-of-ontology corpus · record hagrid_run2_q00007

A correct cited answer at G1 that G2 cannot certify: wiki geography has no governed vocabulary, so authorization has nothing to authorize. Tightening turns a slope into a cliff.

G0 • Naive

no governance

Based on the context, Virginia is directly north of North Carolina.

✓ correct — uncited

G1 • Cited

citations required

Virginia is the state directly north of North Carolina [\[CHNK_PRIMARY\]](#).

✓ correct + cited

G2 • Groundedauthorized +
grounded evidence

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked

G3 · Strict

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked**G4 · Corroborated**multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✗ blocked**B3 · EXPERTQA — WHERE GOVERNANCE BEATS NAIVE****“Why do pregnant women often suffer from iron deficiency?”**

NOT answerable from corpus · abstention probe · record expertqa_run3_q00065

The evidence for this question is not in the corpus. Naive answers anyway — judged **WRONG**. Every governance level correctly declines. On abstention-heavy corpora this is why governed configurations outscore naive overall (65% vs 55%).

G0 · Naive

no governance

Based on the provided context, the explanation is incomplete because the text cuts off. However, the text begins to explain that "it is normal for every woman to see a drop in hemoglobin."

✗ answered — judge: WRONG**G1 · Cited**

citations required

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

✓ correct refusal**G2 · Grounded**authorized +
grounded evidence

Governance Boundary: Evidence insufficient.

✓ correct refusal**G3 · Strict**

strict authorization

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✓ correct refusal**G4 · Corroborated**multi-source
corroboration

Governance Boundary: All retrieved evidence violated D5 authorized predicates. Response blocked.

✓ correct refusal

Provenance & selection. Examples selected by stated criteria (transition profiles quantified in Analysis_CrossRun §2: staircase, reshaping, false-rejection, and each corpus's modal pattern) — not for favorability; the false-rejection and non-monotone failure cases are included deliberately. All outputs verbatim from SHA-256-sealed archives (results/run1_delucionqa + run1_rejudge, run2_hagrid, run3_expertqa; git tags run1/2/3-complete,

